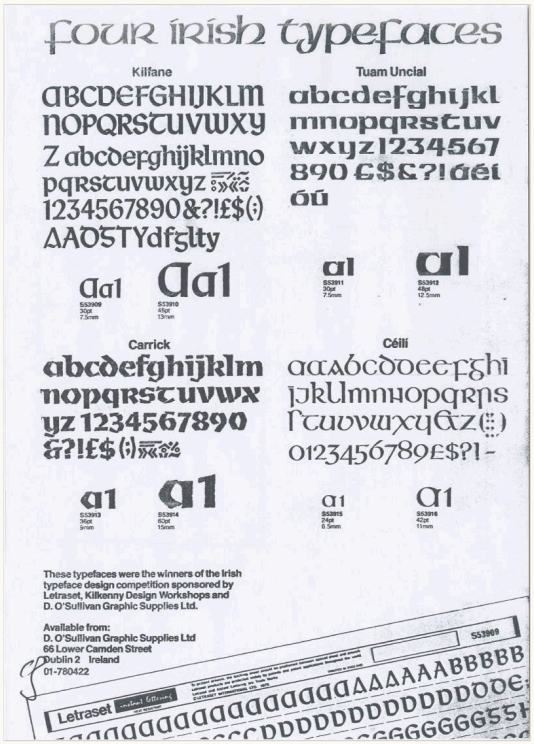
four irish typefaces

Céilí · Carrick · Kilfane · Tuam Uncial — winners of the 1978 “Design an Irish Typeface” competition, sponsored by Letraset, Kilkenny Design Workshops and D. O’Sullivan Graphic Supplies. Digitised 2026, version 2.000. Fonts copyright 2026 Dan Drayne, free to use under the SIL Open Font License 1.1 (openfontlicense.org).



Céilí — Hermann Hecht, first prize. **Carrick** — William Curran, second prize. **Kilfane** — William Curran, joint third. **Tuam Uncial** — Jarlath Hayes, fourth place (highly commended).

The faces were issued as Letraset dry-transfer sheets S53909–S53916 and sold through D. O’Sullivan Graphic Supplies, Dublin. Kilfane is reported on the Series C Irish banknotes; Tuam Uncial on Clannad sleeves and the Glenroe credits; Céilí on National Library of Ireland booklets.

These fonts were traced from the flyer shown here (left). Each was completed to about 400 characters: Irish with the traditional lenition dots and ꝉ, Scottish Gaelic, Welsh, and the Latin-script languages of Western and Central Europe, with kerning, mark positioning and the original alternates as stylistic sets. Glyphs not shown on the sheet were drawn to match each face.

The sheet shows one style of each. Version 2 adds new work drawn in 2026 from those regulars: an italic for all four, and a bold and bold italic for Céilí and Kilfane (Carrick and Tuam Uncial are already black).

Kilfane

William Curran · joint third prize · 1978 “Design an Irish Typeface” competition (Letraset · Kilkenny Design Workshops · D. O’Sullivan)

Banc Ceannais na hÉireann

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789 £$€&?!(;:)

Is fearr Gaeilge bhriste ná Béarla cliste. Tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. Ní neart go cur le chéile.

A ċara, mo ġrá ċú! A Ṡeáin, cá ḃfuil do máċair? Ceol 7 craic.

Ciamar a tha thu? Tha gu math, tapadh leibh. Fàilte gu Dùn Èideann!

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog. Sphinx of black quartz, judge my vow — “1978”. Is fearr Gaeilge bhriste ná Béarla cliste. Tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. Ní neart go cur le chéile.

SS01 · ROMAN FORMS

Is fearr Gaeilge bhriste ná Béarla cliste. Tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. Ní neart go cur le chéile.

SS02 · INSULAR FORMS

Is fearr Gaeilge bhriste ná Béarla cliste. Tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. Ní neart go cur le chéile.

THE 1978 FLYER THIS WAS TRACED FROM



KILFANE — CHARACTER SET (ALTERNATES SHADED)

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KILFANE — THE FAMILY

REGULAR — Banc Ceannais na hÉireann

ITALIC — *Banc Ceannais na hÉireann*

BOLD — **Banc Ceannais na hÉireann**

BOLD ITALIC — ***Banc Ceannais na hÉireann***

An italic, a bold and a bold italic, drawn in 2026 from the 1978 regular. The bold is the regular redrawn with a wider pen in the face’s own contrast, its counters and openings kept by hand where the pen would close them; the italic is the regular narrowed four per cent, its stems restored, and sloped eight degrees.

REGULAR — abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

ITALIC — *abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz*

BOLD — **abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz**

BOLD ITALIC — ***abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz***

Tír gan teanga, *tír gan anam*. Ní neart go cur le chéile, **agus ar scáth a chéile *a mhaireann na daoine***.

REGULAR · 15 — Is fearr Gaeilge bhriste ná Béarla cliste. Tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. Ní neart go cur le chéile. Ciamar a tha thu? Tha gu math, tapadh leibh. Fàilte gu Dùn Èideann!

ITALIC · 15 — *Is fearr Gaeilge bhriste ná Béarla cliste. Tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. Ní neart go cur le chéile. Ciamar a tha thu? Tha gu math, tapadh leibh. Fàilte gu Dùn Èideann!*

BOLD · 15 — **Is fearr Gaeilge bhriste ná Béarla cliste. Tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. Ní neart go cur le chéile. Ciamar a tha thu? Tha gu math, tapadh leibh. Fàilte gu Dùn Èideann!**

BOLD ITALIC · 15 — ***Is fearr Gaeilge bhriste ná Béarla cliste. Tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. Ní neart go cur le chéile. Ciamar a tha thu? Tha gu math, tapadh leibh. Fàilte gu Dùn Èideann!***

Tuam Uncial

Jarlath Hayes · fourth place (highly commended) · 1978 “Design an Irish Typeface” competition (Letraset · Kilkenny Design Workshops · D. O’Sullivan)

Fáilte go Tuaim

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789 £$€&?!(;:)

Unicase: capitals and lower case share the same forms, as on the 1978 sheet.

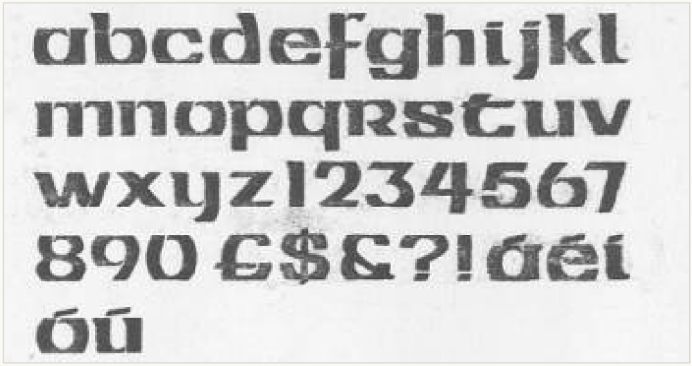
Is fearr Gaeilge bhriste ná béarla cliste. Tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. Ní neart go cur le chéile.

A Chara, mo grá tú! A Seáin, cá bhfuil do mhátair? Ceol 7 craic.

Ciamar a tha thu? Tha gu math, tapadh leibh. Fàilte gu dùn èideann!

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog. Sphinx of black quartz, judge my vow — “1978”. Is fearr Gaeilge bhriste ná béarla cliste. Tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. Ní neart go cur le chéile.

THE 1978 FLYER THIS WAS TRACED FROM



TUAM UNCIAL — CHARACTER SET (ALTERNATES SHADED)

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TUAM UNCIAL — THE FAMILY

REGULAR **fáilte go tuaim**

ITALIC ***fáilte go tuaim***

An italic, drawn in 2026 from the 1978 regular: narrowed four per cent, its stems restored, and sloped eight degrees. The face is already black (stems over a third of the x-height), so there is no bold: a heavier cut would close its counters and its hairline cuts.

REGULAR abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

ITALIC *abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz*

tír gan teanga, *tír gan anam*. ní neart go cur le chéile, *agus ar scáth a chéile a mhaireann na daoine.*

REGULAR · 15 **is fearr gaeilge bhriste ná béarla cliste. tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. ní neart go cur le chéile. ciamar a tha thu? tha gu math, tapadh leibh. fàilte gu dùn èideann!**

ITALIC · 15 ***is fearr gaeilge bhriste ná béarla cliste. tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. ní neart go cur le chéile. ciamar a tha thu? tha gu math, tapadh leibh. fàilte gu dùn èideann!***

carrick

William Curran · second prize · 1978 “Design an Irish Typeface” competition (Letraset · Kilkenny Design Workshops · D. O’Sullivan)

ceol 7 craic

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789 £$€&?!(;:)

Unicase: capitals and lower case share the same forms, as on the 1978 sheet.

is fearr gaeilge bhriste ná béarla cliste. tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. ní neart go cur le chéile.

a ċara, mo ġrá tú! a ṡeáin, cá ḃfuil do ṁáṫair? ceol 7 craic.

ciamar a tha thu? tha gu math, tapadh leibh. fàilte gu dùn èideann!

the quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog. sphinx of black quartz, judge my vow — “1978”. is fearr gaeilge bhriste ná béarla cliste. tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. ní neart go cur le chéile.

THE 1978 FLYER THIS WAS TRACED FROM



CARRICK — CHARACTER SET (ALTERNATES SHADED)

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CARRICK — THE FAMILY

REGULAR **ceol 7 craic**

ITALIC ***ceol 7 craic***

An italic, drawn in 2026 from the 1978 regular: narrowed four per cent, its stems restored, and sloped eight degrees. The face is already black (stems over a third of the x-height), so there is no bold: a heavier cut would close its counters.

REGULAR **abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz**

ITALIC ***abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz***

tír gan teanga, *tír gan anam*. ní neart go cur le chéile, *agus ar scáth a chéile a mhaireann na daoine*.

REGULAR · 15 **is fearr gaeilge bhriste ná béarla cliste. tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. ní neart go cur le chéile. ciamar a tha thu? tha gu math, tapadh leibh. fàilte gu dùn èideann!**

ITALIC · 15 ***is fearr gaeilge bhriste ná béarla cliste. tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. ní neart go cur le chéile. ciamar a tha thu? tha gu math, tapadh leibh. fàilte gu dùn èideann!***

Céilí

Hermann Hecht · first prize · 1978 “Design an Irish Typeface” competition (Letraset · Kilkenny Design Workshops · D. O’Sullivan)

Céilí mór anocht!

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789 £$€&?!(;:)

Unicase: capitals and lower case share the same forms, as on the 1978 sheet.

Is fearr Gaeilge bhriste ná béarla cliste. Tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. Ní neart go cur le chéile.

a chara, mo grá tú! a sheáin, cá bfuil do mháthair? ceol 7 craic.

Ciamar a tha thu? tha gu math, tapadh leibh. fàilte gu dùn èideann!

the quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog. sphinx of black quartz, judge my vow — "1978". Is fearr Gaeilge bhriste ná béarla cliste. tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. ní neart go cur le chéile.

SS01 · INSULAR R AND S

Is fearr Gaeilge bhriste ná béarla cliste. tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. ní neart go cur le chéile.

SS02 · UNCIAL A AND N

Is fearr Gaeilge bhriste ná béarla cliste. tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. ní neart go cur le chéile.

SS03 · ALTERNATE A D E J L V

Is fearr Gaeilge bhriste ná béarla cliste. tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. ní neart go cur le chéile.

THE 1978 FLYER THIS WAS TRACED FROM



CÉILÍ — CHARACTER SET (ALTERNATES SHADED)

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CÉILÍ — THE FAMILY

REGULAR — Céilí mór anocht!

ITALIC — *Céilí mór anocht!*

BOLD — **Céilí mór anocht!**

BOLD ITALIC — ***Céilí mór anocht!***

An italic, a bold and a bold italic, drawn in 2026 from the 1978 regular. The bold is the regular redrawn with a wider pen in the face’s own contrast, its counters and openings kept by hand where the pen would close them; the italic is the regular narrowed four per cent, its stems restored, and sloped eight degrees.

REGULAR — aócdefghíjklmnopqrstuvwxyz

ITALIC — *aócdefghíjklmnopqrstuvwxyz*

BOLD — **aócdefghíjklmnopqrstuvwxyz**

BOLD ITALIC — ***aócdefghíjklmnopqrstuvwxyz***

Tír gan teanga, *tír gan anam*. Ní neart go cur le chéile, **agus ar scáth a chéile *a mhaireann na daoine***.

REGULAR · 15 — Is fearr Gaeilge bhriste ná béarla cliste. Tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. Ní neart go cur le chéile. Ciamar a tha thu? Tha gu math, tapadh leibh. Fàilte gu dùn èideann!

ITALIC · 15 — *Is fearr Gaeilge bhriste ná béarla cliste. Tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. Ní neart go cur le chéile. Ciamar a tha thu? Tha gu math, tapadh leibh. Fàilte gu dùn èideann!*

BOLD · 15 — **Is fearr Gaeilge bhriste ná béarla cliste. Tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. Ní neart go cur le chéile. Ciamar a tha thu? Tha gu math, tapadh leibh. Fàilte gu dùn èideann!**

BOLD ITALIC · 15 — ***Is fearr Gaeilge bhriste ná béarla cliste. Tír gan teanga, tír gan anam. Ní neart go cur le chéile. Ciamar a tha thu? Tha gu math, tapadh leibh. Fàilte gu dùn èideann!***